



OBJECTION HANDLING

"Treat objections as requests
for further information."

— *BRIAN TRACY*

This is the backup plan. Not the plan.

HOW TO USE THIS DOCUMENT

Objection Handling SOP • Intro

Covers: philosophy, structure, and the universal pattern underneath every objection

Before we start: this SOP is the backup plan, not the plan.

The purpose of your presentation is to get to the end of the call with **zero objections**. The twelve pillars exist for a reason — when each one is delivered properly, every objection in this document is *pre-handled* before the prospect ever has the chance to raise it.

So if you're hitting objections at the end of a call, the first thing to ask isn't "*how do I handle this?*" — it's "*which pillar did I not execute well enough?*" Pricing objections mean the offer pillars didn't land. Trust objections mean the warranty/Lloyd's frame wasn't anchored. Partner objections mean qualification failed. Time and comparison objections almost always mean the urgency and specialist frame didn't get installed.

This document is here for when the presentation is sound but the prospect still flinches at the close. It's not a substitute for the pillars — it's a safety net underneath them. **Use it as evidence of what to fix in the next call, not as the engine of this one.**

THE PHILOSOPHY

Objections aren't fights. They're the prospect telling you, in code, that something hasn't landed yet. The rep who treats them as combat loses. The rep who treats them as information wins.

Every play in this document is built on the same idea: **calm beats forceful, questions beat statements, and honesty beats persuasion**. If you find yourself getting louder, faster, or more clever — you've already lost the room. Slow down. Ask. Listen. The deal is in what they haven't told you yet, not in what you can convince them of.

Above all: **never sound rehearsed**. The lines in this document are the structure, not the script. Internalise the move, then deliver it in your own voice — Australian, casual, like you're talking to a mate who's about to make a stupid decision and you're trying to gently stop them.

THE UNIVERSAL PATTERN

Every objection in this SOP follows the same three-move shape:

- **Move 1 — Take the pressure off.** Acknowledge the objection without flinching. Don't argue, don't agree, just *receive* it. This stops them defending and starts them thinking.
- **Move 2 — Surface the real objection.** The first thing out of their mouth is rarely the real reason. Use a question to find what's actually sitting underneath.

— **Move 3 — Reframe, then close.** Once you've found the real objection, run the play that handles it. Then ask the closing question — and stop talking.

If you have to go further than three moves, you're chasing. Chasing kills more deals than the original objection ever did. Every chapter ends with **Move 4 — the high-intent follow-up booking** — because when the deal isn't there in this sitting, the right move isn't to keep pushing, it's to lock the next conversation properly.

HOW TO READ THE FORMATTING

- **Quoted lines** — example rep language. The actual words to say.
- *Italic gray* — tonality cues and stage directions. How to deliver, not what to say.
- **[BRACKETED GOLD]** — placeholders for your specific numbers, names, or details.
- **Yellow-bar callouts** — core principles, key reminders, or anchoring quotes. Read these twice.

BEFORE YOU EVER TOUCH THIS SOP

Objection Handling SOP • Pre-Flight

Covers: the qualification rule that engineers half the objections out of existence

BOTH DECISION-MAKERS ON THE CALL. ALWAYS.

If only one partner is on the call, you've already lost. Not because you can't sell to one person — but because the second person becomes a phantom objection you can't answer. Every *"I need to talk to my wife / husband / partner"* is unwinnable in the room because the person who needs convincing isn't there.

This is why there's no **Third-Party Deferral** chapter in this SOP. The objection should never reach you. If it does, you've made a qualification mistake earlier in the funnel — and there's no script that fixes a qualification failure mid-call.

The rule

When booking the call, both decision-makers must confirm attendance. If only one is available, **reschedule**. Don't run the call hoping it'll work out. It won't.

Earned, not avoided: if you skip this rule and only get one partner on the call, the partner objection is one you've earned. Take it on the chin and tighten the qualification next time.

PRICING

Chapter 1 of 4 • Objection Handling

Covers: *too expensive · can you do it cheaper · weren't planning to spend that much · smaller system would be fine*

FIRST MOVE — REFRAME THE LENS

Don't argue the price. Reframe what "price" actually means.

"Interesting — depends how you view it though."

Tonality: curious. Said like you're about to share something genuinely interesting, not a sales counter. Pause for a beat — let them ask what you mean, or just let the silence pull them forward.

"The people who end up wealthiest aren't the ones who look at something and straight away go 'way too expensive.' That's actually how you miss out on opportunities — how you stay stuck paying the power companies stupid amounts of money forever. The wealthy ones don't react to the price tag and immediately shut it down. They actually take a second to understand the investment and assess whether it's a smart long-term move for them. They look at whether it gives them a good return, and they make sure it's safeguarded with no risk on your end. And all those boxes are ticked here. So the only question is whether you keep paying the power companies forever, or you start paying into something you actually own — something that's paying you back and giving you benefit."

Tonality: matter-of-fact + genuine. The whole thing should feel like advice from a friend who's seen it work, not a sales reframe. Then look at them with intrigue. Not selling — just curious whether it's landed.

IF THEY PUSH — "YEAH BUT IT'S STILL TOO MUCH"

Don't push the same lever harder. Switch from telling to asking.

"Fair enough. When you say too much — are you comparing it to what you're currently paying on power, or is it just more than you wanted to spend per month?"

Tonality: curious + casual. Doesn't really matter which one they say, because the answer's the same:

"Right, so here's the thing. Your power bill is [X] a month right now — and that's not guaranteed to stay there. It's gone up every year, it'll keep going up, that's just what power companies do. The system on the other hand is [X] a week, locked in, doesn't spike, doesn't move. So you're either going to keep paying a number that climbs every year into something you'll never own — or you redirect that same money into an asset sitting on your own home that's actually paying you back. Same money leaving your account either way. The only difference is where it lands and what you've got to show for it at the end."

Tonality: matter-of-fact throughout. Don't oversell it — just lay out the comparison cleanly and let the maths land on its own.

IF THEY STILL PUSH

You don't go a third round on price. You've made the case. Going harder makes you the desperate guy. Pivot to honesty:

"Look, I'm not here to talk you into something you're not comfortable with. If price is genuinely the wall, I'd rather know now. How could we make this number a little more digestible for you? At the end of the day we want to help."

Tonality: genuine + helpful. Highlight the actual cost on screen as you say "this number." You're not negotiating against yourself — you're inviting them to be straight with you about what would work.

Either they give you a number you can work with, or they reveal it wasn't price at all — it was something else wearing a price costume.

TIME / DECISION-DELAY

Chapter 2 of 4 • Objection Handling

Covers: think about it · sleep on it · now's not the time · wait and see · we'll get back to you

THE TRUTH ABOUT THIS OBJECTION

"Think about it" is almost never about thinking. It's a polite shutdown that hides the real reason — usually price, partner, finance, or just a lack of certainty. Your job isn't to fight it. Your job is to systematically rule out everything else until the actual objection shows itself.

FIRST MOVE — TAKE THE PRESSURE OFF, THEN TEST THE FIT

"Yeah of course, no stress."

Tonality: calm + casual. Disarm immediately. The pressure-off line is what makes them stop defending and start listening.

"Just so I understand though — how do you feel about the fit? Do you like [COMPANY NAME], do you feel like we'd have your back and look after you guys long term?"

Tonality: curious + genuine. Wait. Almost always: "Yeah."

"Oh, why do you say that? Because obviously there's a lot of different companies you could go with."

Tonality: curious. Let them justify it. They'll bring up the system, the fit, the partnership themselves — in their own words. Stronger than you pulling each piece out separately.

SECOND MOVE — SURFACE THE REAL OBJECTION

"Right, so the fit's right, you're happy with the system. Listen, my best intention here is to help — what's actually making you think it's not sensible to lock this in today?"

Tonality: genuine + direct. You've earned the right to ask the harder question because you've just confirmed they like you. One of three things happens:

- They name a real objection (price, finance, etc.) → **jump to that handle**
- They go quiet → **silence is your friend, let them sit in it**
- They say "I just never make quick decisions / I always think about things" → **go to Move 3**

THIRD MOVE — DEPLOY THE CERTAINTY HANDLE

When they hold the line as a personality position, it's almost always not about "thinking" — it's about wanting 100% certainty. See the **Certainty Handle** page for the full play. Validate the trait, then puncture the belief that more time will give them more certainty.

FOURTH MOVE — LOCK THE HIGH-INTENT FOLLOW-UP

If they still hold after the Certainty Handle, don't push. Pivot to the **High-Intent Follow-Up Booking** play (dedicated page). Don't let them off the call with "I'll think about it and get back to you" — that's how follow-ups die.

COMPARISON / SHOPPING AROUND

Chapter 3 of 4 • Objection Handling

Covers: look at other companies · get other quotes · shop around · what about [competitor]

THE TRUTH ABOUT THIS OBJECTION

Same root as "think about it" — they're not 100% certain and they want space to confirm they're making the right call. The difference is they think looking at *more options* is going to give them that certainty. It won't. Three more quotes just gives them three more numbers and three more sales pitches to weigh up.

Don't engage with the shopping logic. Step around it and run the same play as Time/Delay.

FIRST MOVE — TAKE THE PRESSURE OFF, THEN TEST THE FIT

"Yeah of course, that makes sense."

Tonality: casual + fair. Validate the instinct without conceding the objection. Don't get defensive about being compared.

"Just so I understand though — how do you feel about the fit? Do you like [COMPANY NAME], do you feel like we'd have your back and look after you guys long term?"

Tonality: curious + genuine. Wait. Almost always: "Yeah."

"Oh, why do you say that? Because obviously there's a lot of different companies you could go with."

Tonality: curious. Let them justify it. They're now selling themselves on you in their own words. Same machine as Time/Delay — you're getting them to articulate why you are the right fit before you address why shopping isn't necessary.

SECOND MOVE — SURFACE THE REAL OBJECTION

"Right, so the fit's right and you're happy with the system. Listen, my best intention here is to help — what's actually making you think it's not sensible to lock this in today instead of going and looking around?"

Tonality: genuine + direct. One of three things happens:

- They name a real objection (price specifically, finance, etc.) → **jump to that handle**
- They go quiet → **silence is your friend, let them sit in it**
- They say "I just want to make sure / want to compare / always shop around" → **go to Move 3**

THIRD MOVE — DEPLOY THE CERTAINTY HANDLE

Same play as Time/Delay. The underlying problem is identical — they want 100% certainty and they think shopping will give it to them. The Certainty Handle shows them it won't.

FOURTH MOVE — LOCK THE HIGH-INTENT FOLLOW-UP

If they still hold after the Certainty Handle, don't push. Pivot to the **High-Intent Follow-Up Booking** play. Don't let them off the call with "we'll get back to you after we've shopped around." Lock the next conversation properly.

THE CERTAINTY HANDLE

Reusable Tool • Used in Chapters 2 & 3 (Move 3)

Covers: *what to do when they hold the line as a personality position*

When to deploy

Use this play when the prospect has agreed the fit is right, agreed the system is right, agreed the partnership is right — but is still holding back, citing some version of *"I just always think about things"* or *"I just want to make sure."*

Pre-condition check: they must have already agreed the deal makes sense. If they haven't, you're deploying certainty against real disagreement — and you'll lose. Surface what they actually disagree with first, then come back here.

THE PLAY

Don't fight the trait — validate it. Then puncture the belief sitting underneath: that more time, or more shopping, will give them certainty. It won't. Nothing does.

"Yeah, fair enough — and honestly, that's a smart way to be. People who make rash decisions usually get burnt. But let me ask you — do you think maybe that comes from not being 100% certain in the investment? Because if you were 100% certain, you'd obviously do it hey."

Tonality: genuine + fair. Validate before you challenge. Then ask the diagnostic question with real curiosity. Customer typically agrees.

"Yeah of course. But here's the thing — can you ever be 100% certain about anything? Even if I for example went to the best school in the world — Harvard, studied my whole life, got the degree — can I be 100% certain I'm going to get the job I want? No. You can never be 100% certain about anything."

Tonality: calm + direct. The Harvard analogy collapses the certainty fantasy. Don't rush — let it land. Nobody is 100% certain about anything that matters, so waiting for certainty is waiting forever.

"Same here — you could keep thinking about this for weeks, months, and you still wouldn't know 100% it's the right move. Nobody ever does on anything that matters. But what I do know is — 3, 6, 12 months from now, when you're looking back on your bills and your credits, you're going to be saying 'thank god we did that.' You're going to be happy with yourself in this moment."

Tonality: confident + warm. The future-self projection flips the time axis. They stop comparing now-vs-later and start comparing future-with-vs-future-without.

"So to be in that situation — what decision do you have to make right now to put you guys in that position 3, 6, 12 months from now where you're saving a heap of money?"

Tonality: curious + direct. The closing question forces them to articulate the action that gets them to the better future. Most people, when asked, will say it themselves.

WHAT'S ACTUALLY HAPPENING HERE

- **Validate the trait** — "smart way to be" disarms them. Nobody wants to be the rash decision-maker.
- **Diagnose the real problem** — "is it because you're not 100% certain?" surfaces the truth without you having to argue them into it.
- **The Harvard reframe** — collapses the certainty fantasy. Nobody is 100% certain about anything that matters, so waiting for certainty is waiting forever.
- **Future-self projection** — flips the time axis. They stop comparing now-vs-later and start comparing future-with-vs-future-without.
- **The closing question** — forces them to articulate the action that gets them to the better future. Most people, when asked, will say it themselves.

If they close → "Perfect, let's lock it in." · If they still hold → drop to the High-Intent Follow-Up Booking play.

FINANCE

Chapter 4 of 4 • Objection Handling

Covers: don't want more debt · rather not finance it · don't like loans · want to pay cash

THE TRUTH ABOUT THIS OBJECTION

It's not really a finance objection — it's an **identity objection**. People who say "I don't want more debt" are usually saying "I don't want to feel like the kind of person who takes on debt." The reframe is showing them they already have debt. They just haven't called it that.

THE MOVE

"Yeah I get that — nobody likes the word 'debt.' But here's the thing — you already have debt. You just don't think of it that way. Over the next 10 years, you're locked in to pay the power company tens of thousands of dollars. That's a guaranteed bill leaving your account every single month for the rest of your life. That's debt. The only difference is there's no contract sitting in front of you to remind you of it."

Tonality: genuine + matter-of-fact. The puncture line is "you already have debt — you just don't think of it that way." Said calmly, not as a gotcha.

"So really, you're not choosing between debt and no debt. You're choosing between debt that costs you forever and gives you nothing back, or debt that pays itself off in a few years and then keeps paying you for another 20. One you own at the end. The other you just keep renting until you die."

Tonality: direct. "Renting until you die" is the sting line — said as fact, not as a sales punch. Let it land.

"Which one actually sounds like a smart financial position to be in?"

Tonality: curious. Force them to answer. Most won't say "the renting one."

IF THEY PUSH — "YEAH BUT I JUST DON'T LIKE LOANS ON MY NAME"

"Fair — and if that's a hard line for you, I respect that. But just so we're clear: this isn't a loan in the traditional sense. It's secured against the asset, the repayment is less than what you're already paying on power, and the system pays itself off. So your credit position actually improves over time — you're servicing a payment that's covered by what you're already spending, on something that adds value to your home. It's the opposite of bad debt."

Tonality: calm + direct. Don't apologise for finance — defend it factually.

IF THEY STILL PUSH

"All good. If financing isn't your thing, we can look at a cash option. What works better for you — keeping cash in the bank and letting the system pay for itself, or putting cash down upfront?"

Tonality: casual + curious. Give them the dignity of a choice. Forces them to engage with the actual money, not the word debt.

THE HIGH-INTENT FOLLOW-UP BOOKING

Reusable Tool • Used in Chapters 2, 3 & Closing

Covers: the exit play when the deal isn't here today — locks the next conversation properly

When the deal isn't here today, this is the exit

When you've worked the chapter, deployed the Certainty Handle, and they're still holding — don't keep pushing. The right move is to lock the next conversation **properly**. Not casually. Not vaguely. The same high-intent booking play from the **Post-Presentation Follow-Up Framework**.

Why this matters: a vague follow-up dies. "I'll think about it and get back to you" is a soft no with a polite delivery. A live-booked, specific, time-bound follow-up keeps the pipeline alive — and the rep with a steady follow-up rhythm doesn't have slow weeks the way everyone else does.

THE BOOKING PLAY

"I completely appreciate that, [NAME] — to be honest, I'm pretty similar myself, I don't like making big decisions on the spot either."

Tonality: genuine + casual. Disarm by agreeing with their instinct.

"We're pretty under the pump at the moment as you can imagine with the [REBATE / INITIATIVE], so let me squeeze in a quick 30 [DAY or DAY+1] to go over everything in detail and answer anything that's come up for you over the next couple of days, just to help you guys out."

Tonality: reasonable + helpful. External pressure ("under the pump") + specific timeframe ("30 minutes [DAY or DAY+1]") + real value ("answer anything that's come up").

"If that sounds fair, just let me know what day works better."

Tonality: casual + curious. Closed choice — they're choosing between two days, not deciding whether to follow up at all.

WHY THIS WORKS

- **Agreement** — "I'm pretty similar myself" — disarms instantly.
- **External pressure** — "under the pump with the rebate" — scarcity that's about the company, not your ego.
- **Specific timeframe** — "30 minutes [DAY or DAY+1]" — concrete, close, hard to refuse.
- **Real value** — "answer anything that's come up" — gives them a reason to show up.
- **Closed choice** — "what day works better?" — they're choosing between two days, not deciding whether to follow up at all.

IF THEY PUSH BACK ON THE DATE — "WE CAN'T DECIDE BY THEN"

Run the manager extension play. You're not asking permission to sell — you're asking permission to fight for them.

"I completely understand — I do want you guys to be 100% comfortable in your decision."

Tonality: genuine + reasonable.

"I'll tell you what. Let me see if I can give my manager one last call to see if I can get approval on extending the time you have to look over everything. Do you mind holding the line one more time? I'll try my best, guys, for you, honestly."

Tonality: considering + advocating + sincere. Brief pause before "I'll tell you what" — looking up, deep in thought, like you're working something out. Sell the moment, not the line.

COMING BACK FROM THE MANAGER

"All good — just spoke with management. Best they can do is hold the [OFFER / PRICING / INCLUSION] for [EXTENDED DATE]. We can't push it past then, but that gives you guys a proper window to sit with it. Are you happy to lock in [DAY] at [TIME] to pick it back up?"

Tonality: casual + matter-of-fact + authoritative. Re-lock the follow-up at the new date. Same high-intent framing.

The full follow-up cadence (post-call email + SMS, mid-window prompt, night-before reminder, follow-up call structure, no-show flow) lives in the Post-Presentation Follow-Up Framework — work it from there.

WHEN NOTHING LANDS

Objection Handling SOP • Closing

Covers: the gracious exit that protects the relationship and the next conversation

KNOW WHEN TO STOP

Sometimes the deal isn't there in this sitting. That's fine. The worst thing you can do is keep pushing past three moves. You'll come across as desperate, you'll burn the relationship, and you'll lose the chance at the follow-up. **Stopping at the right time is part of the play, not a failure of it.**

THE EXIT

When the chapter's exhausted and the prospect's not closing, drop straight into the **High-Intent Follow-Up Booking** play. Not a casual *"I'll give you a call sometime"* — the proper play. Live, specific, externally-pressured, closed-choice. The same booking machinery the Post-Presentation Follow-Up Framework runs.

WHAT YOU'VE PROTECTED

- **The relationship** — they remember you as the rep who didn't pressure them, which is rare.
- **The follow-up** — a specific day in the diary, locked live, beats *"I'll give you a call sometime"* every time.
- **The pipeline** — every properly-booked follow-up is a deal warming up in the background. Reps with a steady follow-up rhythm don't have slow weeks the way everyone else does.
- **Your own headspace** — desperate calls cost you the next ten calls. Calm exits don't.

THE MINDSET

You're not here to win every deal in the room. You're here to win the deals that should be won, and to leave the rest in a state where they might come back. Reps who chase every deal kill more pipeline than they save.

Calm professional wins. Always.

BONUS REFRAMES

Objection Handling SOP • Extra Plays

Covers: five additional moves to deploy when standard plays don't land — pick what fits the moment

How to use this section

These are extra plays that don't sit inside the four chapters. They earn their place when used at the right moment. Each one comes with a clear **what it does**, **when to use**, and **when NOT to use** — read all three before deploying.

The standard chapters cover 90% of objections. These reframes are for the 10% where you need a sharper diagnostic, extra weight, or an emotional reframe to break through. **Don't reach for them first** — work the standard play, and only reach for these when the customer is still holding.

Ordered softest to heaviest. Reframes 1 and 2 are diagnostics — they surface what's really going on. Reframes 3 and 4 add weight by reframing the cost or the pattern. Reframe 5 is the heaviest emotional move and only works after rapport is deep. Work down the list as needed.

1. THE 1-TO-10 CALIBRATION QUESTION

What it does

Forces the customer to articulate where they actually are on the decision spectrum, then surfaces the specific gap between where they are and where they need to be to close. It's a calibration tool, not a discovery tool — you're not trying to find new objections, you're stress-testing whether the existing case has actually landed.

When to use

- At or near the close, after the customer has seen the full maths (post-aha reveal)
- When you can't read the room — they've gone non-committal but you don't know why
- As an alternative to "what's holding you back?" when that question keeps getting vague answers

When NOT to use

- Earlier in the appointment — they don't have a real number to give you yet
- If they give a low number (4 or 5) and you push past it with another close — handle the gap first
- Repeatedly — once you've used it and addressed the gap, don't redeploy until you've actually moved them

The script

"Okay guys, just to help me understand where you're at — on a scale of 1 to 10. One being this is the worst investment you've ever seen in your life, makes no sense, you're going to lose money on it. Ten being this is a great investment, it makes you money back, there's no risk, the ROI is good. Where are you guys at right now with how this is feeling?"

Tonality: casual + curious. NOT loaded. Said like you're genuinely interested in their answer, not setting up a closing technique. The whole move dies if you sound like you're running a play.

Customer responds — usually 7 or 8.

"Eight — that's not bad. What would make it a 10?"

Tonality: casual + curious. Same energy. Don't pounce on the answer — let them think.

Customer surfaces the actual concern. This is what makes the move powerful — it forces them to articulate the specific gap.

Now address whatever they said specifically — anchor back to the maths, the guarantees, the warranty structure, whatever resolves it.

"Cool. So now — feeling 10-ish?"

Tonality: casual + light. The recalibration confirms whether you've actually closed the gap. If yes, lock it in. If they're still hesitant, you've got a deeper objection — go back to the relevant chapter.

If they give a low number (4 or 5)

Don't push past it with another close. Surface the gap directly:

"Okay, that's lower than I'd expect — what's the main thing pulling that number down?"

Then handle the real objection that surfaces. Don't redeploy the 1-to-10 until you've actually moved them.

Pairs well with

Time/Delay and **Comparison** — use as a diagnostic at the close, before deploying Move 4 (High-Intent Follow-Up Booking). If the 1-to-10 surfaces a real gap you can move, you might not need the follow-up at all.

2. WHAT WOULD MAKE THIS A NO?

What it does

Inverts the standard discovery question. Instead of asking "what's holding you back?" (which lets them stay vague), it forces them to articulate the negative case — to imagine telling someone else why they walked away. Most indecisive customers can't construct a convincing no, which surfaces that the hesitation isn't a real objection.

When to use

- When Move 2 of a chapter ("what's making you think it's not sensible?") gets a vague or fluffy answer
- When the customer is dodging the direct question with hesitation rather than naming a reason
- When you suspect there's no real objection — just nervousness about deciding

When NOT to use

- If they've already named a real concern — handle the actual concern instead
- Aggressively or as a gotcha — it has to land as a thought experiment, not a challenge
- If rapport is shaky — the move requires them to trust your intent

The script

"Okay fair enough. Let me flip it on you then — what would make this a no for you? Because from what you've said, the fit's right, the system's right, the partnership's right. So if you were to walk away from this and tell your mate at the pub 'nah, didn't go with them' — what's the reason you'd give?"

Tonality: curious + casual. Don't deliver this aggressively — it's a thought experiment, not a challenge. Wait. Don't fill the silence.

What happens next

- They surface a real concern → **jump to that handle**
- They fumble trying to give one → confirms it's not a real objection → **deploy the Certainty Handle**
- They go quiet → silence is doing the work — let them sit in it

Pairs well with

Time/Delay and **Comparison** Move 2. Use when the standard "what's making you think it's not sensible to lock this in today?" gets a vague answer. The flip forces clarity without pressure.

3. HOW MUCH HAS NOT DECIDING ALREADY COST YOU?

What it does

Reframes the cost equation. Up till now they've been weighing *cost of acting* vs *cost of nothing*. This makes the *cost of nothing* visible — every month of delay is already money they've handed to the power company instead of into something they own. Particularly powerful when they've mentioned earlier in the call that they've been thinking about solar for a while.

When to use

- After the Certainty Handle's Harvard reframe but before the future-self projection — adds weight before the closing question
- When the customer needs to feel the cost of continued delay before they'll decide
- Especially powerful if they've mentioned looking at solar for months or years already

When NOT to use

- As a guilt trip — the "not to make you feel bad" line is mandatory, not optional
- On price-objection customers — they're already worried about cost, doubling down on it backfires
- On first-time solar shoppers who haven't been delaying — there's no past delay to anchor to

The script

"And honestly — can I ask you something? How much has not deciding on this already cost you up to this point? Because your bills have been climbing for years. Every month you've been thinking 'maybe one day' is another month you've handed over to the power company instead of into something you own. That's already cost you thousands. Probably tens of thousands by now."

Tonality: genuine + curious. Don't deliver this as a guilt trip — deliver it as an honest observation. The point isn't to make them feel bad about the past, it's to make the cost of continued delay impossible to ignore.

"I'm not saying that to make you feel bad about it. But I think the real question isn't whether this costs too much — it's whether you can afford another year, two years, five years of the same delay that's already cost you so much."

Tonality: warm + matter-of-fact. The 'not to make you feel bad' line is critical — without it, this lands as a dig. With it, it lands as a friend pointing something out.

Pairs well with

The Certainty Handle. Drop it in after the Harvard reframe and before the future-self projection. The cost-of-inaction makes the future-self projection that follows hit harder — they're now picturing both the regret of past delay *and* the regret of future delay.

4. DON'T REPEAT THE SAME MISTAKE THAT GOT YOU HERE

CONDITIONAL PLAY — ONLY DEPLOY IF YOU HAVE EVIDENCE OF A DELAY PATTERN. Setter notes show they've spoken to other companies before. They've mentioned "we've been looking at solar for years." They've explicitly told you they delay decisions in general. Without that evidence, this move lands as preachy and burns the rapport. With it, it lands as a friend pointing out a blind spot.

What it does

Uses the customer's own delay pattern as evidence. They can't argue with their own history. The move makes the *pattern itself* the problem they need to solve — not the deal in front of them. Powerful because it shifts the question from "is this the right deal?" to "is the way I'm making this decision actually working for me?"

When to use

- Setter notes confirm they've talked to multiple companies over a long period
- They've explicitly mentioned looking at solar for months or years
- They've described themselves as "someone who always thinks things over" — and you've already deployed the Certainty Handle without breaking through

When NOT to use

- Without the pattern evidence — it lands as judgement, not insight
- If rapport is anything less than rock-solid — this move has bite, it requires trust to land as care
- As your first attempt at closing — work softer moves first, this is a sharpening, not an opening

The script

"Yeah, I hear you. And listen — I don't want you to feel any pressure on this. But can I ask you something, and I'm asking genuinely?"

"You mentioned you've been looking at solar for [X amount of time / a few years now / a while]. Do you think maybe the reason you're in this exact situation right now — still paying the power company a fortune, still getting smashed by these rates — is because of that pattern of putting the decision off?"

Tonality: genuine + curious. NOT smug. NOT smartass. The whole move only works if it lands as care, not as judgement.

"Because if that pattern's what got you here... do you reckon making the same call again is going to get you somewhere different? I'm not trying to be a smartass — I just don't want you to look back in another two years wishing you'd done it now."

Tonality: warm + sincere. The "I'm not trying to be a smartass" line is non-negotiable. It's the inoculation that keeps the move from feeling like an attack. Without it, the previous question lands as condescending. With it, it lands as honest concern.

What happens next

- They engage with the question → you've broken the pattern → pivot to the closing question

— They push back defensively → you've gone too hard → back off, return to softer moves, rebuild rapport

Pairs well with

The Certainty Handle, after Harvard but before the future-self projection. Use as an upgrade to the Certainty Handle when standard moves haven't broken through and the delay-pattern evidence is there.

5. THE BURNING HOUSE ANALOGY

What it does

Reframes the rep's urgency from *manipulation* to *responsibility*. When the customer is delaying for vague reasons and starting to perceive your push as salesy, this analogy flips the dynamic — you're not pressuring them, you're being a friend who can see the situation clearly. The heaviest emotional move in the SOP.

When to use

- Delay objections — *"now's not a good time" / "let's revisit in a few months" / "I want to wait and see"*
- After the customer has agreed the maths makes sense but is still holding back
- When you sense the customer is starting to read your urgency as pressure

When NOT to use

- Price objections with real reasons underneath — the analogy will land as emotional manipulation on a real concern
- Before the customer has agreed the deal makes sense — if they haven't said yes to the maths, this reads as forcing
- If rapport is shaky — this is a heavy move and only lands if they trust you

The script

"Can I ask you a question, guys? Have you heard of the burning house analogy?"

Tonality: genuine curiosity. Not setting up a sales line — actually asking.

"If you saw someone trapped inside a burning house, you wouldn't politely respect their comfort. You wouldn't say 'take your time.' You wouldn't walk away just because you didn't want to be annoying. You wouldn't think 'I'll get back to them later.'"

Tonality: calm + matter-of-fact. Said like a thought experiment, not a sermon.

"Because when someone is in a bad situation, urgency isn't manipulation, and it's not someone trying to force you into something. It's responsibility."

Tonality: certainty. The reframe line — let it land.

"If I saw a friend of mine getting ripped off on a deal, paying way more than they needed to for something — and I saw a much better solution that would genuinely help them — I'd want the best for them. I'd want them to know."

Tonality: genuine + warm. Personal — said like you mean it, because at this point you should.

"That's why I do this, guys. Not because I'm trying to push you into anything — because I genuinely believe what we're showing you here is the better situation."

Tonality: sincere + grounded. This is the lock-in line. Don't rush it. The whole move fails if you sound performative on the close.

Pairs well with

Use after the **Certainty Handle** when the customer has logically agreed but is emotionally still holding back. The Certainty Handle handles the *head*; this handles the *heart*.

WHAT'S NOT IN THIS SOP — AND WHY

Objection Handling SOP • Appendix

Covers: the objections that got cut, and what to do if they ever come up

TRUST / CREDIBILITY — HANDLED IN THE PRESENTATION

There's no chapter for "how do I know you'll be around in 25 years / what's the catch / you sound too good to be true." Not because it doesn't get asked — it does — but because it's not really an objection if your warranty structure is solid.

Every variant of "how do I know I'm not getting screwed" collapses into the same answer: **your warranty isn't backed by us — it's backed by Lloyd's of London**, the largest and oldest third-party insurance provider in the world. Once you've laid that out properly during the presentation, the objection has nowhere to go. The work is done before they ask the question.

If it does come up at the end of the call

"Yeah, fair question. Honestly? You don't know — and you can't know — whether any company will be around in 25 years. That's just the truth. But here's the thing: your warranty isn't actually with us. It's backed by Lloyd's of London — the largest and oldest third-party insurance provider in the world. They've been around for hundreds of years. So even in the worst case scenario where we disappeared tomorrow — which we're not going to — your system, your warranty, your protection is still 100% covered. You're not betting on us. You're betting on Lloyd's. And I reckon they're a pretty safe bet."

THIRD-PARTY DEFERRAL / PARTNER — ENGINEERED OUT

There's no chapter for "I need to talk to my wife / partner / accountant." See the **Pre-Flight** page. Both decision-makers must be on the call. If only one is on, you've earned the objection by failing the qualification — and there's no script that fixes it mid-call.

Accountant / financial advisor variants are different — but they almost always collapse back into the Certainty Handle. The prospect is outsourcing certainty to a third party because they don't have it themselves. Run the Certainty Handle and the need for the third party usually evaporates.

IF SOMETHING ELSE COMES UP

If a prospect throws an objection that doesn't fit any of these chapters, the universal pattern still applies:

- **Take the pressure off** — "yeah, fair enough"
- **Surface the real objection** — "just so I understand, what specifically is the bit that's worrying you?"
- **Reframe and close** — answer what they actually said, then ask for the decision



— **If nothing lands** — drop to the High-Intent Follow-Up Booking play

Most novel objections turn out to be one of the four chapters in disguise. Diagnose what's actually underneath, then run the right play.